The Golden Road

Dunedin Rogaines and NZRA

Saturday 12th July

Report and Comments, Bob Cunninghame, 25th July 2014

Well, eventually we got there and 101 people enjoyed the mild, almost spring-like weather and the country surrounding El Dorado station. Our thanks to the several landowners and particularly Murray Eason, whose woolshed provided the base.

Thanks to everyone who came and particularly the strong contingent from Christchurch – the support was appreciated. Several of these participants will be at the World Rogaining Championships in mid-August. We wish them well.

There is not a lot to say apart from mentioning the two contentious checkpoints.

Number 55 was misplaced – circle not centred. It should have been just over the index contour to the south. For this I take full responsibility and apologise to those who spent time searching the lower copses.

Number 43 – this was in a large pit where several trees had fallen, inside the plantation. Careful reading of the map shows the track bend marked is actually outside the plantation. Greig Hamilton and Matt Scott were the only ones who pointed this out and I agree with them – now! Again I take responsibility. Check on Google maps to see this quite clearly – I should have done so myself when planning!

In spite of the above, Greig and Matt are to be congratulated in visiting all checkpoints and returning with 22 minutes to spare. Had we had time for another four check points on the NW corner, they may well have got them all; but with little time to spare.

It was in several ways a trying event to organise, with the earlier cancellations due to clashes and low entries. Then when I looked out from the stone yards at Queen's Birthday weekend to see gullies with their bits of pink marking cloth all full of snow, I had some misgivings. The snow did go, but we reduced the area as a precaution and the time from 13 to 11 hours for the long event. Our Dunedin organisation is thin on the ground; but it is encouraging to have had a good number of local people participating – particularly in the 6-hour and family options. We shall build on this response and there will be another rogaine over an adjacent area during the coming autumn. We have provisional permission from the three major landowners. It is similar, largely open country – farmland, tussock, deeply incised valleys and gullies, rock outcrops and some scrubby parts. Matt Bixley will have a rogaine/adventure course in this period too; but the two will be well spaced apart. Offers to help with organisation are always appreciated!

Thanks for being there,
Bob Cunninghame.